Because it described the situation we faced at the time and because several of the issues raised in that speech were so important, I'm including substantial excerpts from it here:

> In spite of a stagnating Soviet economy, Soviet leaders invest twelve to fourteen percent of their country's gross national product in military spending—two to three times the level we invest. I might add that the defense share of our United States federal budget has gone way down . . . in 1962, when John Kennedy was President, forty-six percent, almost half, of the federal budget went to our national defense. In recent years, about one quarter of our budget has gone to defense, while the share for social programs has nearly doubled.
>
> The combination of the Soviets spending more and the United States spending proportionately less changed the military balance and weakened our deterrent. Today, in virtually every measure of military power, the Soviet Union enjoys a decided advantage.
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> The Soviet Union has deployed a third more land-based intercontinental ballistic missiles than we have. Believe it or not, we froze our number in 1965 and have deployed no additional missiles since then.
>
> The Soviet Union put to sea 60 new ballistic missile submarines in the last fifteen years. Until last year we hadn't commissioned one in that same period. The Soviet Union has built over 200 modern Backfire bombers and is building 30 more a year. For twenty years, the United States has deployed no new strategic bombers. Many of our B-52 bombers are now older than the pilots who fly them.
>
> The Soviet Union now has 600 of the silos considered most threatening by both sides—the intermediate-range missiles based on land. We have none. The